



Capstone Discovery + PRD-Light

Week 8 • Day 2 • AI Spec Development & Capstone

TPM Academy



Day 2 Objectives

- Run **compressed customer discovery** in 35 minutes
- Name the **persona / JTBD / pain points** for the capstone subject
- Draft **PRD-light §§1–7** — 2 pages, full discipline
- Apply the **compression discipline**: cut what's cosmetic; keep what's load-bearing
- Validate with AI; plan tomorrow's compressed architecture work



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Inputs gathered overnight; pin discovery summary plan
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Compressed customer discovery
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	PRD-light §§1–4
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	PRD-light §§5–7
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	AI validation + Day-3 setup

Block 1 — Compressed Discovery

Week-1 muscles in 35 minutes



The Compression Discipline

Compressed work is **not** lower-quality work. It's **selective**: keep what's load-bearing, cut what's cosmetic.

- §1 Context (½ page)
- §2 Problem (½ page)
- §3 Goals + non-goals (½ page)
- §4 Scope (in/out table)
- §5 Solution sketch (½ page)
- §6 Top 6–8 ACs
- §7 Top 5 NFRs (one per category)

2 pages total. Every word earns its place.



Compressed Persona

```
**Persona:** <role += "" segment="">  
**Job-to-be-done:** <verb-based, in="" their="" language="">  
**Why it's hard today:** <specific friction;="" quote="" a="" real="" customer="" if="" possible=""></specific></verb-based,></role>
```

Worked example:

"Persona: New B2B finance ops associate at a 200-person company.
JTBD: Close the books each month without staying late on Friday. Why
hard: 'I spend Thursday night chasing 4 different teams for missing
accruals — by the time they respond, I've forgotten what I asked.'"

Activity 1 — Compressed Discovery

Triads • 35 minutes

- 10 min: synthesize gathered inputs
- 10 min: name persona / JTBD / why hard
- 10 min: top 3 pains scored on severity / frequency / addressability
- 5 min: sanity check — does this sound like a real customer?



10 + 10 + 10 + 5

Block 2 — PRD-Light §§1–4

Context, Problem, Goals/Non-goals, Scope

AI Assistance Pattern

Triad members **solo-draft first**. Pick the strongest. **Then** apply AI to tighten.

```
Role: Editor for a TPM's PRD context section.  
Context: <triad's draft="" $1="" +="" discovery="" summary="">  
Task: Tighten this section to ½ page max. Preserve the  
customer quote. Preserve the strategic anchor. Cut anything  
that sounds like marketing language.  
Constraints:  
- Do not invent customer signal  
- Flag any claim that needs source backing  
Format: Tightened $1 + a "what I cut" note.</triad's>
```

Activity 2 — PRD-Light §§1–4

Triads • 40 minutes

- 15 min: §1 + §2 (solo drafts → triad picks → AI tightens)
- 15 min: §3 goals + non-goals
- 10 min: §4 scope (in/out table)



15 + 15 + 10

Block 3 — PRD-Light §§5–7

Solution sketch, AC, NFRs



AC Coverage (Compressed)

Path	Count
Happy	3
Sad	2
Weird	1

Compressed = **fewer ACs**, not weaker ACs. Use Given/When/Then. Same 5-failure-mode discipline.



NFR Coverage (Compressed)

- 1 **Performance** NFR (latency target with defense)
- 1 **Security** NFR (auth/authz)
- 1 **Accessibility** NFR (WCAG floor)
- 1 **Observability** NFR (the leading indicator)
- 1 **Compliance** NFR (the regime that applies)

Each uses the **requirement / defense / verification** template. Defense is non-optional.

Activity 3 — PRD-Light §§5–7

Triads • 40 minutes

- 10 min: §5 solution sketch (no implementation)
- 15 min: §6 ACs (3 happy / 2 sad / 1 weird)
- 15 min: §7 NFRs (5 categories, one each)



10 + 15 + 15

Block 4 — AI Validation + Day-3 Plan

Catch the issues; set up tomorrow's architecture

PRD-Light Validation Prompt

Role: Senior PM reviewing a compressed PRD.

Context: <paste prd-light="" §§1-7="">

Task: Identify 5 issues:

1. A claim that lacks evidence
2. A goal that's actually an output
3. A non-goal that's missing
4. An AC that's untestable or vague
5. An NFR that's boilerplate

Constraints:

- Be specific
- Suggest a concrete fix

Format: 5 numbered findings.</paste>



Day-3 Setup

Plan ahead before leaving today:

1. **3 architectural questions** a senior architect would ask reading PRD-light
2. **Integration map sketch** — systems / data / APIs in scope
3. **Critical path** — what must ship by EOD tomorrow vs Thursday?

Activity 4 — Validation + Day-3 Plan

Triads • 45 minutes • Wrap

- 15 min: AI validation pass (adopt / defer / reject)
- 10 min: update PRD-light + provenance log
- 20 min: Day-3 plan (3 architecture questions, integration sketch, critical path)



15 + 10 + 20 · 15-min wrap



Day 2 Wrap

What we built

- Discovery summary (1 page)
- PRD-light §§1–7 (2 pages)
- AI validation pass
- Day-3 plan

What opens tomorrow

- **Capstone architecture + AI Spec drafted**
- TCD-light + TMD-light
- 5-prompt sequence on the capstone

Bring to Day 3: PRD-light + Day-3 plan. Tomorrow we go architectural.

Questions & Reflection

What was hardest about compressing your PRD work today?